RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

22 OCTOBER 2026

# Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 8:44 PM, Thursday 22 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 161 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 58 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 15,810 minutes at 9:00 PM; no takeoffs or landings since 6:00 PM; Dammam moving again since 8:18 PM after a 7:11–8:18 PM halt

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INCIDENT SUMMARY

## What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 15,810 minutes at 9:00 PM; NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight**.
- No Riyadh takeoffs or landings since 6:00 PM; last movement the permitted Saudia SV934 landing from Amsterdam at 5:04 PM.
- 161 Riyadh flights cancelled so far on Thursday (37%).
- Kuwait, UAE, the GCC chief, the European Parliament and UN chief condemn the Houthi attacks on Dammam airport and Shaybah (4 killed, 10 injured in total); no new strikes or intercepts announced since 2:33 PM.
- Dammam airport halted 7:11–8:18 PM (66 minutes), moving again since 8:18 PM; 4 takeoffs and 13 landings since 6:00 PM, no takeoff since PIA PK246 at 7:11 PM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (15795 min).

| 161 | 0/0 | 3 |
|---|---|---|
| CANCELLED TODAY | TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H | DIVERTED |

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

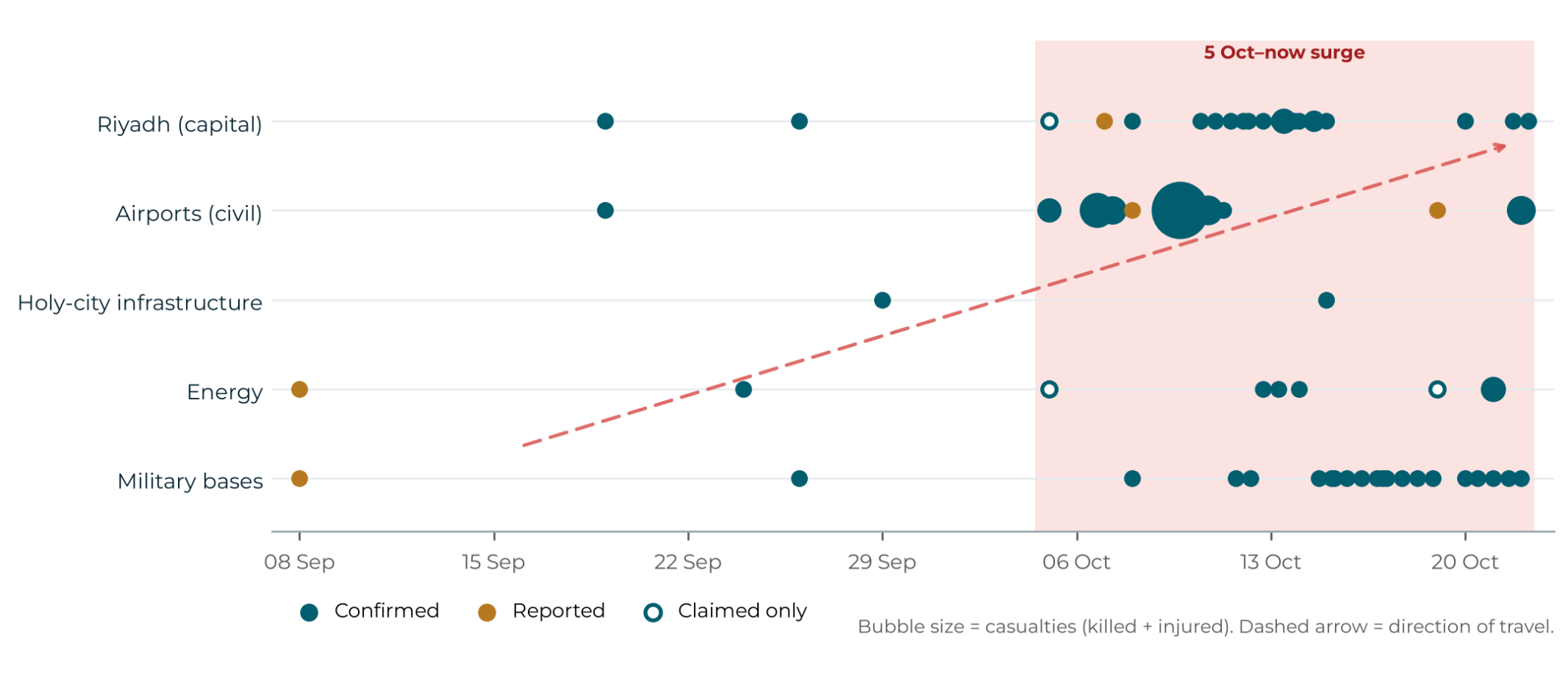
0 takeoffs and 5 landings in the last hour.

| 58 | 0/5 | 2 |
|---|---|---|
| CANCELLED TODAY | TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H | DIVERTED |

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (15,810 min at 9:00 PM); 0 takeoffs and 0 landings since 6:00 PM
- Dammam halted 7:11–8:18 PM (66 min), moving again; 4 takeoffs and 13 landings since 6:00 PM
- No new coalition intercepts or Civil Defense alerts since the 2:33 PM statement; Civil Defense warns against filming interceptions
- Kuwait, UAE, GCC Secretary-General, European Parliament and UN chief condemn the Houthi attacks

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 22 OCT



*62 sourced events since 8 September (54 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: four drones intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh and Madinah regions; targets and casualties not stated (22 Oct, Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.*

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

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ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

## Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 6:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

**No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 6:00 PM AST.**

**Last 24 hours: Attacks 1, interceptions 4.**

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NEWS AND STATEMENTS

## Riyadh airport still halted; Kuwait, UAE, GCC, European Parliament and UN chief condemn Houthi attacks; Dammam moving again after a 66-minute halt

Checked at 8:46 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED DMM **Kuwait condemns the Houthi attack on Dammam's King Fahd airport**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **8:42 PM** · published 8:42 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 8:46 PM

Kuwait condemned what it called the flagrant attack by the Houthi militia on King Fahd International Airport in Dammam (SPA, translated from Arabic).

CONFIRMED **GCC Secretary-General condemns the Houthi attacks on Dammam airport and the Shaybah oilfield**
SPA (@Spa_Eng / @SPAregions) · **8:39 PM** · published 8:39 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 8:46 PM

The GCC Secretary-General condemned the two terrorist attacks by the Houthi militia that targeted King Fahd International Airport in Dammam and the Shaybah oilfield (SPA, 8:13 PM Arabic and 8:39 PM English).

CONFIRMED **European Parliament affirms solidarity with Saudi Arabia and condemns the Houthi attacks**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **8:28 PM** · published 8:28 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 8:46 PM

SPA reports the European Parliament affirmed its solidarity with the Kingdom and condemned the Houthi attacks (translated from Arabic).

CLAIM **Yemeni government forces say 780 strikes on Houthi positions in 24 hours, about 512 fighters neutralised**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **8:21 PM** · published 8:21 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 8:46 PM

Al Ekhbariya relays the Yemeni armed forces' claim that, under operation "Dawn of Yemen", 780 operations in the past 24 hours hit Houthi field commanders, positions and supply lines, neutralising about 512 fighters. Not independently verified.

CONFIRMED DMM **Arab News: Dammam airport and Shaybah attacks killed four people and injured 10 in total**
Arab News (@arabnews) · **7:42 PM** · published 7:42 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 8:46 PM

Arab countries and the Muslim World League condemned the Houthi attacks on King Fahd International Airport in Dammam and the Shaybah oilfield, which Arab News says killed four people and injured 10, consistent with the GACA (2 killed, 8 injured) and Energy Ministry (2 killed, 2 injured) figures.

CONFIRMED DMM **UAE strongly condemns the Houthi attack on King Fahd International Airport**
SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **7:02 PM** · published 7:02 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 8:46 PM

SPA reports the UAE strongly condemned the Houthi attack on King Fahd International Airport in Dammam.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense warns that filming or sharing interception and impact-site information is a legal offence**
Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **6:48 PM** · published 6:48 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 8:46 PM

Saudi Civil Defense (Interior Ministry) warned that filming, publishing or sharing information about countering missiles and drones and where they fall exposes people to legal liability.

CONFIRMED **UN chief Guterres calls Houthi attacks on civilian targets in Saudi Arabia "totally unacceptable"**
Arab News (@arabnews) · **6:21 PM** · published 6:21 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 8:46 PM

Arab News reports UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres condemned Houthi attacks on civilian targets in Saudi Arabia as "totally unacceptable", warning that spreading conflicts were creating "an El Nino of war".

CONFIRMED DMM **Qatar condemns the Houthi attack on Dammam's King Fahd airport**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **5:33 PM** · published 5:33 PM AST Thu 22 Oct (Arabic, translated); checked 5:52 PM

SPA reported that Qatar condemned the Houthi targeting of King Fahd International Airport in Dammam.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport tells travellers to follow official authorities and their airline for airspace updates**
King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **5:45 PM** · published 5:45 PM AST Thu 22 Oct (Arabic, translated); checked 5:52 PM

Replying to a traveller, KKIA said that for the latest updates on the airspace people should follow the competent official authorities or contact their airline directly. No reopening was announced.

CONFIRMED **Muslim World League condemns continued Houthi attacks on the Kingdom**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **4:38 PM** · published 4:38 PM AST Thu 22 Oct (Arabic, translated); checked 5:52 PM

SPA carried the Muslim World League's condemnation of the Houthis' continued attacks on Saudi Arabia.

CONFIRMED **Iraq's foreign minister condemns the recent attacks on Saudi Arabia in a call with Prince Faisal**
Al Ekhbariya / SPA · **4:14 PM** · published 4:01 and 4:14 PM AST Thu 22 Oct (Arabic, translated); checked 5:52 PM

In a phone call, Iraq's foreign minister condemned the recent terrorist attacks on areas of the Kingdom; the Saudi foreign minister backed Baghdad's efforts to lower tension in the region.

CONFIRMED **Bahrain condemns in the strongest terms the continuing Houthi attacks on the Kingdom**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **4:10 PM** · published 4:10 PM AST Thu 22 Oct (Arabic, translated); checked 5:52 PM

SPA reported Bahrain's condemnation of the continuing Houthi terrorist attacks on Saudi Arabia.

CONFIRMED DMM **Egypt, Jordan and India condemn the Houthi attack on Dammam's King Fahd airport**
SPA / Al Ekhbariya · **2:39 PM** · SPA 1:44, 1:57 and 2:39 PM; Al Ekhbariya (India) 1:42 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 2:50 PM

SPA carried statements from Egypt and Jordan condemning the attack on King Fahd International Airport in Dammam (translated from Arabic). India condemned continuing attacks on Saudi civilian and energy infrastructure, naming the Dammam airport and the Shaybah field, and said they must stop immediately.

CONFIRMED **Reuters: Gulf markets fall as fresh Houthi strikes on Saudi Arabia raise regional risk**
Reuters · **2:35 PM** · published 2:35 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 2:50 PM

Reuters reports Gulf stock markets fell on Thursday as the new Houthi strikes on Saudi Arabia raised perceived regional risk.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: 4 drones intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh and Madinah regions**
Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA / Al Ekhbariya · **2:33 PM** · published 2:33 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 2:50 PM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki al-Malki said four drones were intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh and Madinah regions (translated from Arabic). No targets, damage or casualties were stated.

CONFIRMED **UK Defence Ministry says it observed Houthi attacks on Saudi infrastructure and airports that caused casualties**
Arab News / Al Arabiya English · **12:54 PM** · published 12:54 PM AST Thu 22 Oct; checked 2:50 PM

The UK Defence Ministry said it had observed Houthi attacks on Saudi infrastructure and airports resulting in casualties, and that the military support it announced is meant to help Saudi Arabia at this critical moment.

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KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

## Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (15795 min).

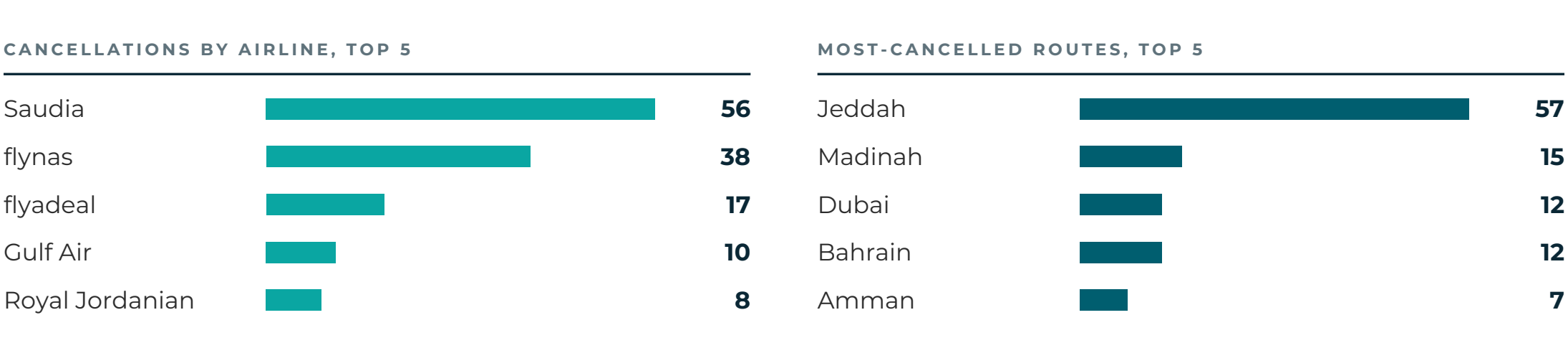
| 161 | 1:52 PM | 5:04 PM | 0 | 3 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY | LAST TAKEOFF | LAST LANDING | TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR | ARRIVALS DIVERTED |
| 73 departures + 88 arrivals, 37% of 440 scheduled. | HZCMJ to Farnborough (non-airline flight), 413 min before 8:44 PM. Last airline: SV978, 1:46 PM. | SV934 from Amsterdam, 220 min before 8:44 PM. | 0 landings in the last hour. | Mostly to Jeddah, Madinah, Qassim. |

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 8:44 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 152 at 8:45 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

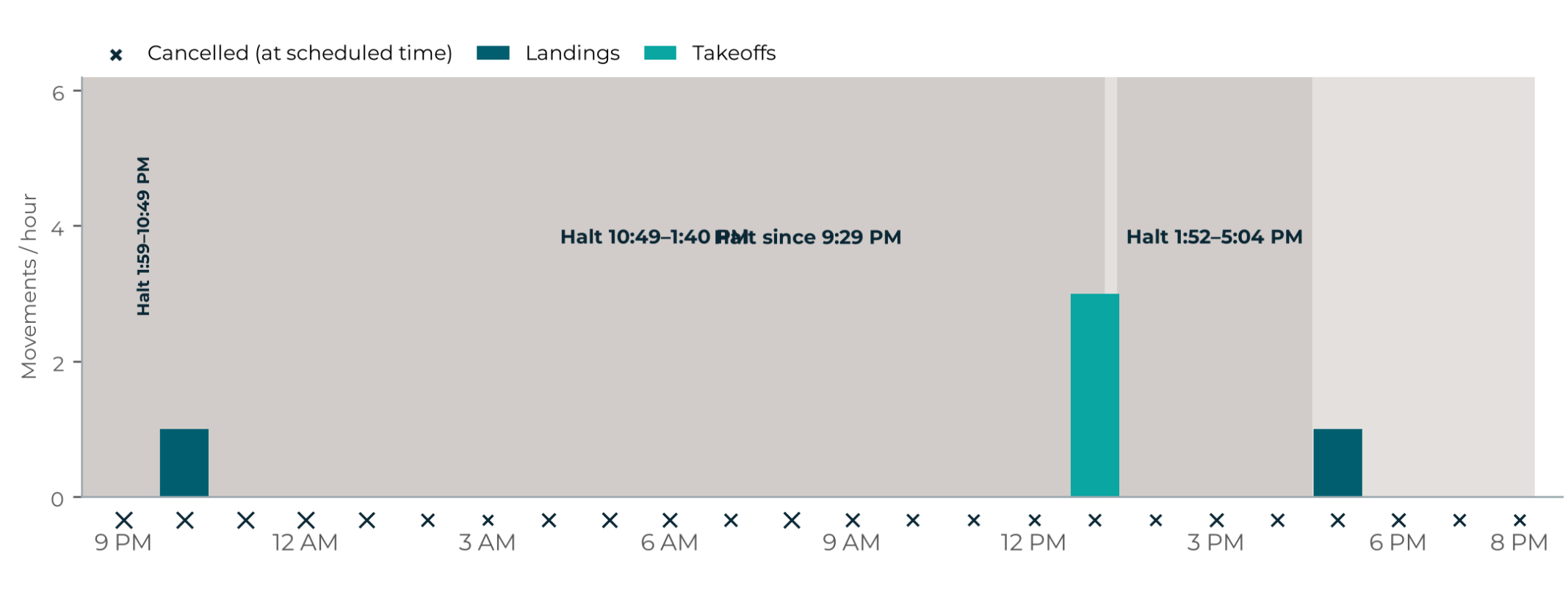
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

| MEASURE | DEPARTURES | ARRIVALS | TOTAL | BASIS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cancelled today, board count | 73 | 88 | 161 | FR24 boards, local day |
| Cancelled today, stats panel | 70 (32%) | 82 (37%) | 152 | FR24 stats panel |
| Delayed today | 2 (1%) | 1 (0%) | 3 | FR24 stats panel |
| On time today (share of operated) | 2 (50%) | 3 (75%) | 5 | FR24 stats panel |
| Average delay, recent flights | 0 min | 0 min | — | FR24 stats panel |
| Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far | 3 of 195 | 1 of 183 | 4 of 378 | FR24 boards |
| Diverted today | — | 3 | 3 | FR24 arrivals board |
| Already cancelled tomorrow | 30 | 33 | 63 | FR24 stats panel |
| Cancelled yesterday (for scale) | 181 | 195 | 376 | FR24 stats panel |

CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5 | MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



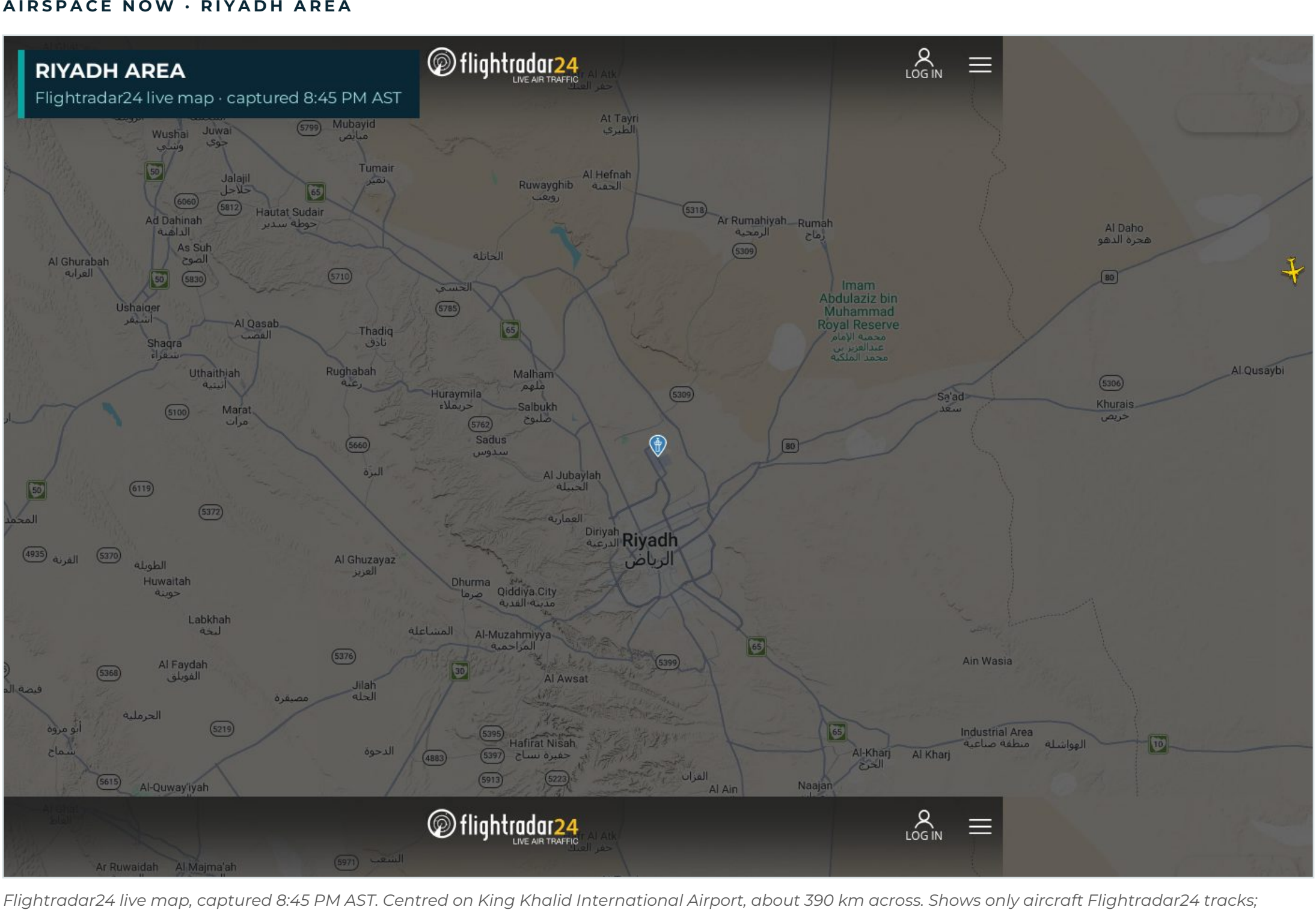
*Recorded takeoffs (3) and landings (2) at RUH per hour from 9:00 PM Wednesday to 8:44 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.*

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are the delayed Saudia SV993 landing at 10:49 PM Wednesday, three permitted takeoffs at 1:40, 1:46 and 1:52 PM and the permitted Saudia SV934 landing at 5:04 PM. Dammam's halts in the window ran 8:54–9:48 PM, 9:56–10:55 PM, 11:17 PM–3:07 AM, 3:07–5:53 AM, 6:47–7:33 AM, 11:25 AM–12:19 PM and 7:11–8:18 PM; none is open.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

| | |
|---|---|
| **Halt 1:52–5:04 PM** | 192 min |
| **Halt 10:49–1:40 PM** | 890 min |
| **Halt 1:59–10:49 PM** | 530 min |
| **OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM** | 15795 min and counting |

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



*Flightradar24 live map, captured 8:45 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.*

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KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

## Dammam airport: disrupted. 0 takeoffs and 5 landings in the last hour.

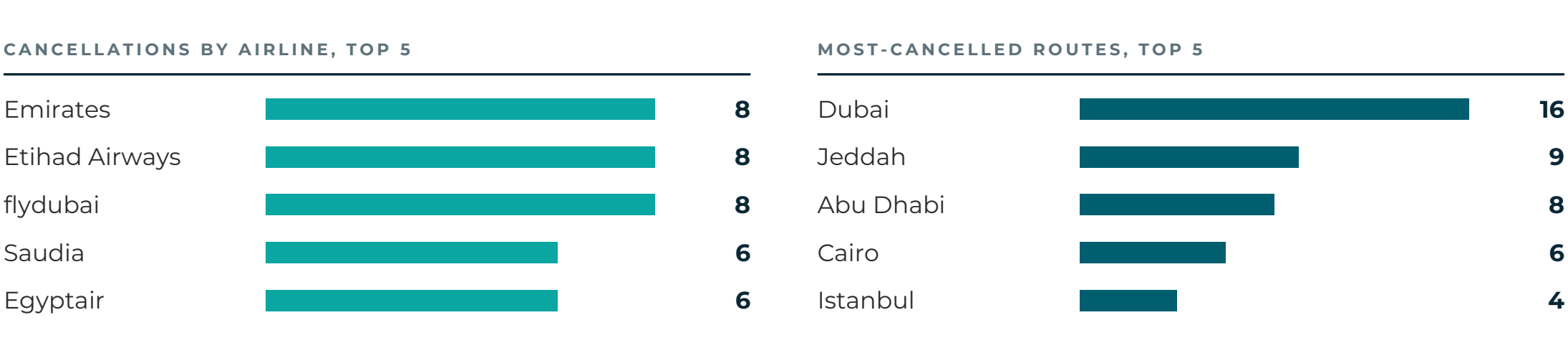
| 58 | 7:11 PM | 8:35 PM | 0 | 2 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY | LAST TAKEOFF | LAST LANDING | TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR | ARRIVALS DIVERTED |
| 30 departures + 28 arrivals, 22% of 258 scheduled. | PK246 to Islamabad, 93 min before 8:44 PM. | XY412 from Jeddah, 9 min before 8:44 PM. | 5 landings in the last hour. | Mostly to Madinah, Bahrain. |

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 8:44 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 56 at 8:45 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

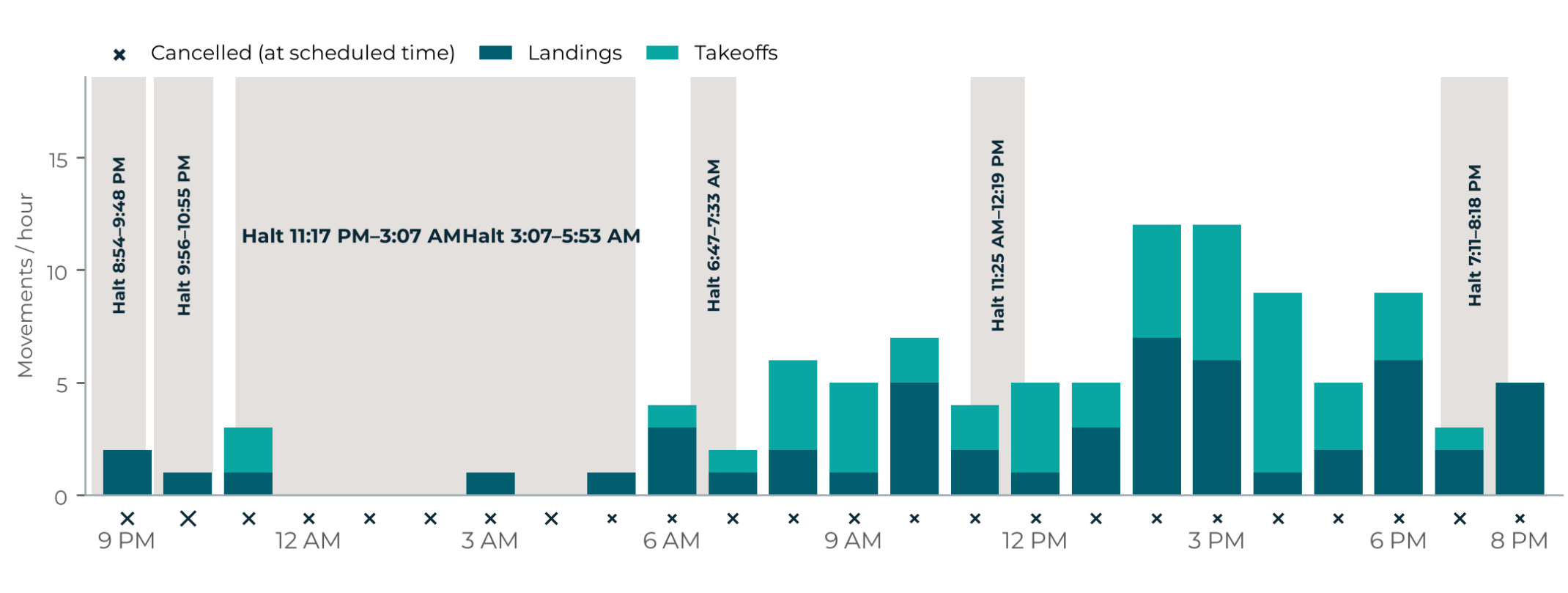
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

| MEASURE | DEPARTURES | ARRIVALS | TOTAL | BASIS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cancelled today, board count | 30 | 28 | 58 | FR24 boards, local day |
| Cancelled today, stats panel | 29 (22%) | 27 (20%) | 56 | FR24 stats panel |
| Delayed today | 43 (33%) | 36 (26%) | 79 | FR24 stats panel |
| On time today (share of operated) | 10 (19%) | 27 (43%) | 37 | FR24 stats panel |
| Average delay, recent flights | 12 min | 26 min | — | FR24 stats panel |
| Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far | 46 of 104 | 49 of 109 | 95 of 213 | FR24 boards |
| Diverted today | — | 2 | 2 | FR24 arrivals board |
| Already cancelled tomorrow | 7 | 9 | 16 | FR24 stats panel |
| Cancelled yesterday (for scale) | 35 | 39 | 74 | FR24 stats panel |

CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5 | MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



*Recorded takeoffs (48) and landings (53) at DMM per hour from 9:00 PM Wednesday to 8:44 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.*

Halt 7:11–8:18 PM (66 min); moving again since 8:18 PM

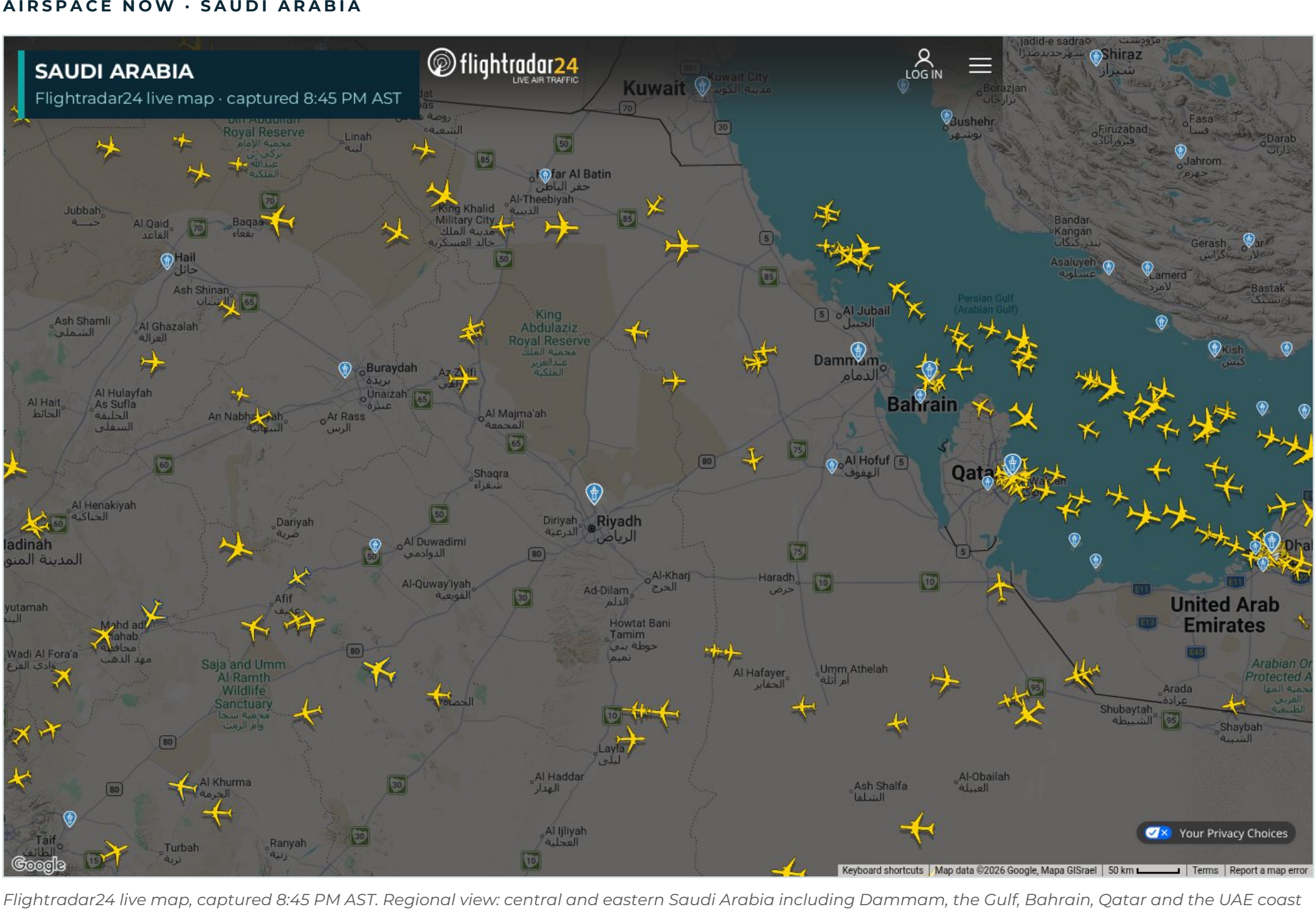
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

| | |
|---|---|
| **Halt 7:11–8:18 PM** | 66 min |
| **Halt 11:25 AM–12:19 PM** | 54 min |
| **Halt 6:47–7:33 AM** | 46 min |
| **Halt 3:07–5:53 AM** | 166 min |
| **Halt 11:17 PM–3:07 AM** | 230 min |

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

- CONFIRMED **Kuwait condemns the Houthi attack on Dammam's King Fahd airport** (SPA (@SPAregions) · 8:42 PM)
- CONFIRMED **Arab News: Dammam airport and Shaybah attacks killed four people and injured 10 in total** (Arab News (@arabnews) · 7:42 PM)
- CONFIRMED **UAE strongly condemns the Houthi attack on King Fahd International Airport** (SPA (@Spa_Eng) · 7:02 PM)
- CONFIRMED **Qatar condemns the Houthi attack on Dammam's King Fahd airport** (SPA (@SPAregions) · 5:33 PM)
- CONFIRMED **Egypt, Jordan and India condemn the Houthi attack on Dammam's King Fahd airport** (SPA / Al Ekhbariya · 2:39 PM)

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



*Flightradar24 live map, captured 8:45 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.*

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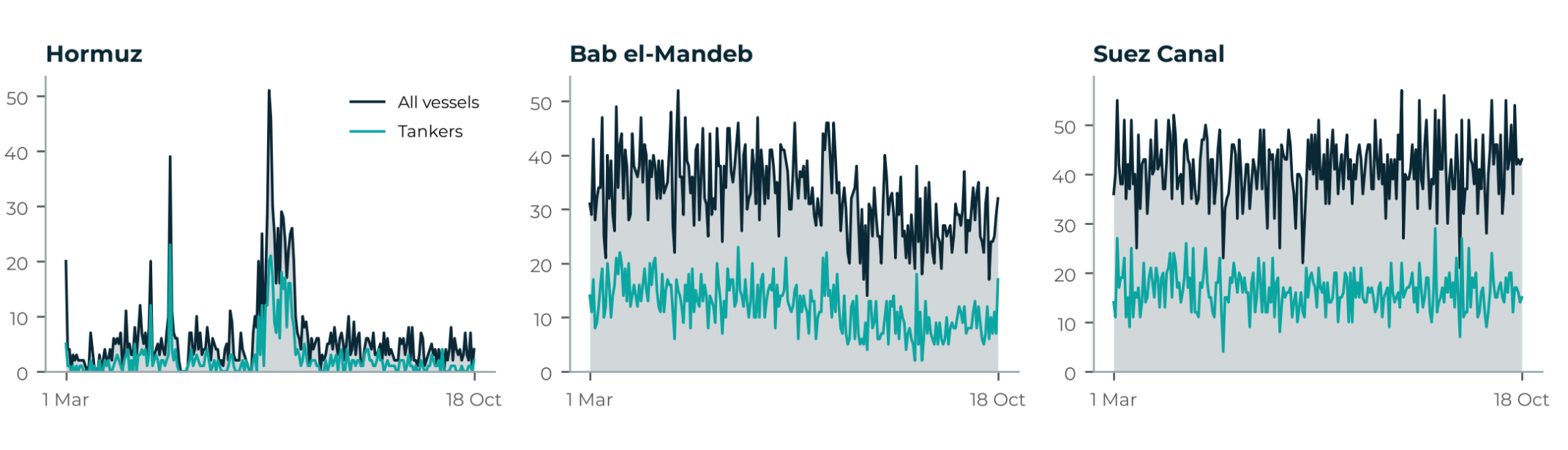
ECONOMY

## Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

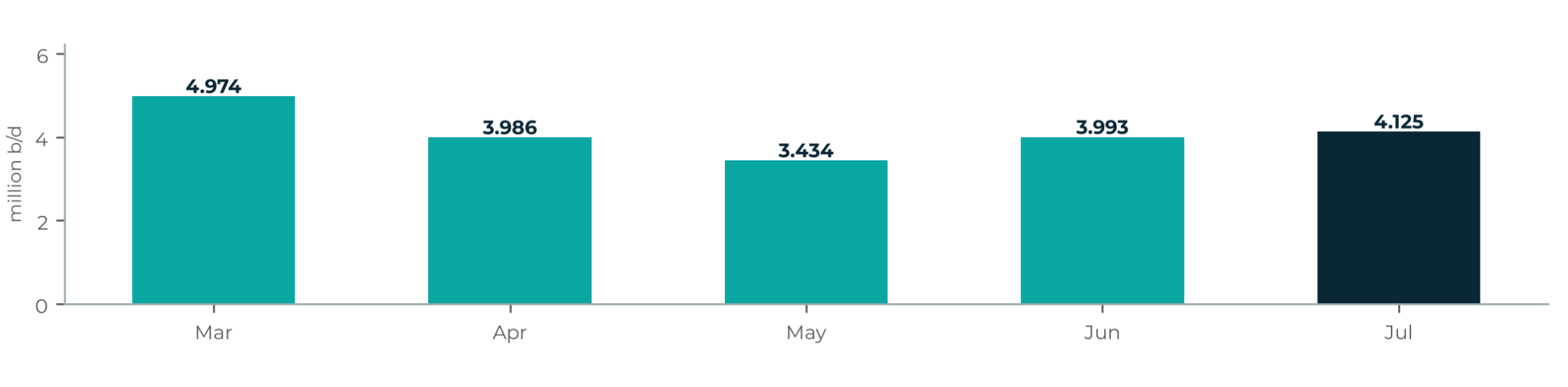
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

| CHOKEPOINT | LATEST DAY | ALL VESSELS | TANKERS | OTHER SHIPS | 7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Hormuz** | Sun 18 Oct | **4** | 2 | 2 | 3.7 (4.1) |
| **Bab el-Mandeb** | Sun 18 Oct | **32** | 17 | 15 | 26.4 (28.3) |
| **Suez Canal** | Sun 18 Oct | **43** | 15 | 28 | 44.3 (41.7) |



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 8:45 PM, Thu 22 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

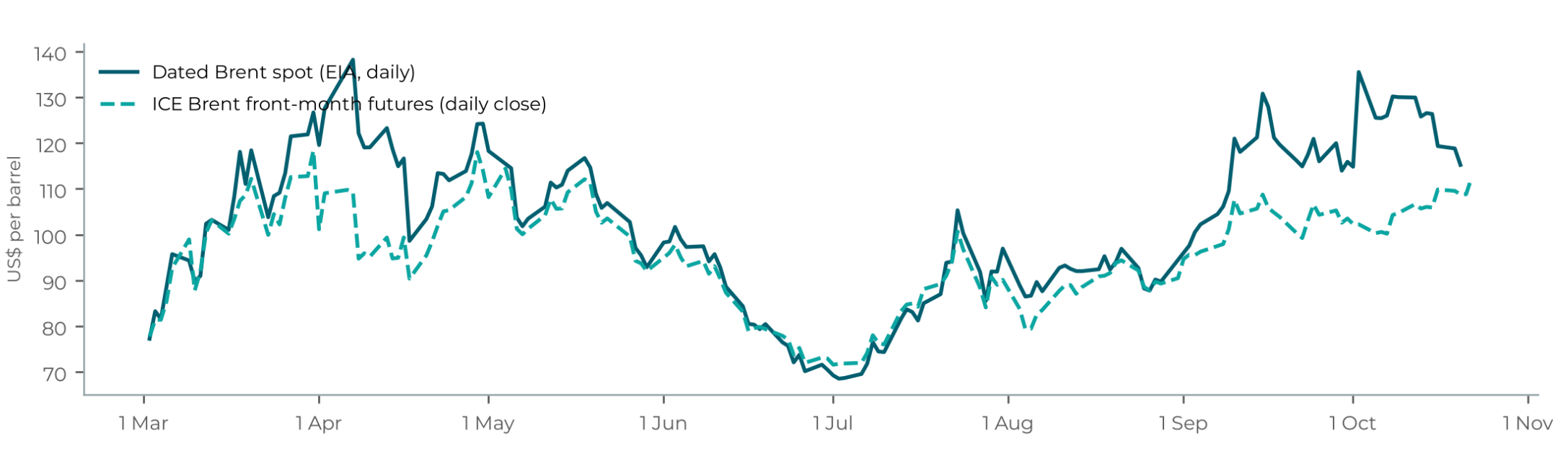


**Monthly, lagged about two months.** Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

*Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).*

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

| $112.56 | $115.22 | -4% | +49% |
|---|---|---|---|
| BRENT FUTURES, LATEST | DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA) | SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE | SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH |
| ICE front-month, 8:35 PM, Thu 22 Oct AST (+3.4% on day). Near real time. | Tue 20 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days. | From $119.66 on Fri 18 Sep. | From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr. |



*Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.*

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METHOD AND LIMITS

## What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 8:44 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

| PREPARED | BOARD DATA AS OF | SOURCES | STATUS | HANDLING | NEXT UPDATE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 8:44 PM, Thu 22 Oct | 8:44 PM | Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA | **RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted** | Open sources · not official | 12:00 AM |

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 12:00 AM